Ford Motor Company

Owner Notification Program 01B77 - Dealer Q&A Updated 07/05/01

- The safety and trust of our customers continues to be our number one priority and guides our every action.
- We are confident that the decision to replace the Firestone tires was made in the best interest of our customers.
- We are going to do everything we can to get replacement tires to our customers as quickly as possible.
- All questions about the decision to replace the Firestone tires should be directed to Ford. Please call Ford Media Information Center at 800-665-1515.

Updated information will be highlighted in "red italics"

General Program Information

Q1. What vehicles are included in this program?
A1. See the program bulletin.

Q2. Are the vehicles safe to drive?
A2. We are not recommending that customers stop driving their vehicles. Ford has found the failure rate on the affected tires to be very low, but higher than comparable tires. The risk factor increases with high temperature. Customers who have tires that have been in service for more than 3 years should verify their 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Wilderness AT tire inflation pressure, and contact their dealer to make an appointment to have their Firestone Wilderness AT tires replaced.

For any tire, it is important to maintain proper inflation pressure (can be found on the tire inflation label located on the driver's door jamb), do not overload the vehicle, and inspect tires periodically for any damage.

Q3. Where can we go for program information, and updates?
A3. QCDealer (http://www.qcdealer.com) will have a special site dedicated to this program. As information is added or updated the information title will marked as "NEW".

Q4. What do I do with a Ford or Lincoln Mercury vehicle not listed in the program letter that has Wilderness AT tires installed?
A4. There will be some Ford or Lincoln Mercury vehicles not listed in the bulletin that may have Firestone Wilderness AT tires; these should be claimed under this program, but will not be active in OASIS. Dealers should contact the Special Service Support Center at 1-800-325-5621 for prior approval before performing the repair, or processing a refund.

Q5. Where can customers go to for information?
A5. Customers can call the Tire Inquiry Hotline at 866-300-1226, or they can e-mail tireinquiry@ford.com.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Q6. I sold a set of Firestone Wilderness AT tires to a retail customer to fit his non-Ford vehicle, are these tires part of the program?

A6. Non-Ford or Lincoln Mercury vehicles with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires **installed by a Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program)** are eligible for replacement. The repair should be submitted using a Warranty/ESP claim type claim form. The dealer **must** enter Program Code "**P19**"; this will allow the repair to be submitted without a VIN. The causal part must be **TIRE**, with the actual part numbers for reimbursement at dealer cost plus 25%, and use actual time for labor reimbursement. These type of claims **cannot** be submitted as a Owner Notification Repair type.

Q7. What information should the technician record on the repair order?

A7. You need to record the:

- VIN
- DOT code from old tires
- Dealer name and address
- Customer name and address

Q8. Why is Ford requesting customers to bring their old tires, or the DOT section of the old tire(s) to the dealership when requesting a refund after the date of the notification letter?

A8. We want to insure that the tires are rendered unusable.

Q9. Will we need to check the DOT code before completing this program?

A9. No, All Firestone Wilderness AT tires are affected regardless of where they were manufactured.

Q10. Some customers may demand a rental vehicle, which would use up my TAP allocation - are you planning to help dealers in some way?

A10. All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers will receive an additional one and one-half (1 ½) month of TAP allocation for ONP 01B77. Refer to the "Increase in Transportation Assistance Program Allocation" All Dealer Letter dated May 22, 2001. (https://www.announcement.dealerconnection.com/announcement/0522_tap.htm)

Q11. Why aren't Wilderness HT tires included in this program?

A11. The HT has a different construction and tread from the Wilderness AT tires. Its performance is superior to the Wilderness AT.

Q12. What do we do if a customer comes in for a refund for four (4) road tires that were already replaced (within the provisions of this program) and now need the non-temporary spare tire replaced.

A12. The dealership should process a refund for the customer for the four (4) road tires previously replaced. The spare tire should be replaced as part of this program – file a related damage claim to cover the spare tire replacement.

Q13. How can we tell if the sections of DOT codes, brought in by customers, were in fact from Firestone Wilderness AT tires?

Q13. Refer to the DOT Code Identification Guide to verify if the DOT codes presented are from Firestone Wilderness AT. See 01B77 Dealer Letter **"What if the Vehicle has a Mix of Affected and Non-Affected Tires"** section for a description of how many tires are eligible for refund. (https://www.announcement.dealerconnection.com/announcement/DOTID.pdf)

NOTE: If sections are brought in for refund with the DOT code defaced dealers should not process the refund.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Q14. During last year's Firestone Recall, a customer replaced Firestone Wilderness AT tires with new Wilderness AT tires. Can I process a refund for the customer?
A14. No, this customer is not eligible for a refund. They are however, eligible to have the Firestone Wilderness AT tires replaced at no charge.

Q15. If a customer replaced their tires before August 1, 2000, are they eligible for a refund?
A15. No, tires purchased prior to August 1, 2000 are not eligible for a refund.

Q16. What should I do with the DOT sections that customers bring in when they request a refund for tires purchased after May 22, 2001.
A16. Dealers must deface (cut in pieces or make unreadable) the DOT sections so they cannot be used to obtain another refund. **If sections are brought in for refund with the DOT code defaced dealers should not process the refund.**

Q17. A customer had their Firestone Wilderness AT tires replaced under the August 9, 2000 Firestone Voluntary Recall. The customer received a letter for ONP 01B77 and the tire(s) used to complete the Firestone Voluntary Recall are not on the current Approved Tire List (but were approved at the time). The customer wants new "Approved Tires". Are they covered under ONP 01B77?
A17. No, ONP 01B77 covers the replacement of 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires only. Tires replaced under the August 9, 2000 Firestone Voluntary Recall other than Firestone Wilderness AT's are not affected. Tires included on the current approved list were prioritized based on their potential production volume. Additional tires from last years list may be added as production volumes increase.

Q18. A customer had affected tires replaced between August 1, 2000 and May 22, 2001 and is seeking refund using the P.O. Box address on the refund form. The customer chooses to return the affected tires to the dealer for disposal. How does the dealer claim for disabling the tires without closing the ONP?
A18. The dealer must enter a repair with a miscellaneous expense code of "Refund" with a dollar value equal to the appropriate labor operation. Do not claim labor operation 01B77G. Claiming with a labor operation 01B77G closes the Owner Notification Program and future repairs, including refunds will not be accepted for payment. For customer tire purchases after May 22, 2001, both the refund and the tire disablement must be claimed by a Ford or Lincoln Mercury Dealer.

Note: *Dealers should follow the* "National Tire Recovery and Recycle Program" for tire disposal", *see announcement for your respective region's rollout date. Rollout of the entire program will be completed by, August 13, 2001.*
(https://www.announcement.dealerconnection.com/announcement/010703_tire.htm)

Information Regarding New Vehicles

Q19. I have a customer with a 2001 Escape who does not want their Wilderness HT tires – can I offer any assistance?
A19. The HT has a different construction and tread from the Wilderness AT tires. Its performance is superior to the Wilderness AT.

Q20. My customer has a new vehicle ordered and does not want Firestone tires – what can I do for the customer?
A20. If the vehicle in question has Firestone Wilderness AT tires they will be replaced as part of this program. If the tires are not Firestone Wilderness AT tires they are not part of this program, and should be handled at the dealer level.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Q21. Why are you still making vehicles with Firestone Wilderness AT tires?
A21. Effective with this program (May 22, 2001) we are stopping production of Ford vehicles with Firestone Wilderness AT tires.

Firestone Wilderness ATX

Q22. What about ATX tires?
A22. ATX tires are not covered in this program. The Firestone Recall Program announced last summer in August 2000 does apply to certain ATX tires.

Q23. Is the Wilderness ATX "Temporary Use" spare used on Ranger vehicles included under this program?
A23. No, these "Temporary" spare tires are excluded under this program.

Replacement Tire Information

Q24. What do we tell customers when we cannot get them tires quickly?
A24. **First**, determine the age of the tires and then prioritize their place on the waiting list. Explain to the customers that we are prioritizing replacements by age of the tire. Firestone Wilderness AT tires have a significantly lower failure rate than the tires recalled last summer, and that the age of the tire has a considerable impact upon its performance. For vehicles equipped with new tires, we have advised customers that they may be placed on a waiting list because tire supplies are limited. For any tire, it is important to maintain proper inflation pressure (can be found on the tire inflation label located on the driver's door jamb), do not overload the vehicle, and inspect tires periodically for any damage.

Second, Ford has developed a list of authorized replacement tires. Please replace customer 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Wilderness AT tire(s) with tire(s) from the authorized replacement tire list. Non-authorized tires have not been thoroughly tested and analyzed on our vehicles and, therefore, we do not recommend the use of any tire not on the authorized list. If authorized tires are unavailable, we recommend customers wait until authorized tires become available.

Third, assure the customer that Ford Motor Company is making extraordinary efforts to make tires available including temporarily shutting down some assembly plants and working with all of the major tire manufacturers to make tires available to your dealership. Goodyear, Michelin, and Continental General tire retailers have been authorized to perform tire replacements at no cost to customers. You may also advise the customer that they are free to pursue getting tires from another source if they so choose. Refer to the program bulletin Attachment I for details on customer refunds.

Q25. What tires will we be able to use under this program?
A25. Ford has developed a list of authorized replacement tires to replace 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Wilderness AT tires. Non-approved tires have not been thoroughly tested and analyzed on our vehicles and, therefore, we do not recommend the use of any tire not on the approved list. If approved tires are unavailable, we recommend customers wait until approved tires become available. The approved tire list will be updated as new tires are added.
(https://www.announcement.dealerconnection.com/announcement/approved_tires.pdf)

Q26. How can I request a specific tire to be added to the "approved tire list".
A26. We are currently testing tires from all major manufacturers. The "approved tire list" will be updated as more tires are tested and approved.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Q27. What is the affect on Ford's bumper-to-bumper tire warranty (for 2001 MY and newer vehicles) if customers purchase tires not on the approved list and claim a refund from Ford?

A27. It depends on the tires purchased. Ford's bumper-to-bumper (BTB) tire warranty covers defects in "factory-supplied" materials, but replacement tires that are original equipment (OE) quality would continue to receive coverage under the BTB warranty. Tires from "off brand" manufacturers, however, would not be covered under the Ford BTB tire warranty, because the specifications are not OE quality. If a dealer believes a customer with "off brand" (e.g. not OE quality) tires should be covered under after-warranty assistance on a case-by-case basis, Field approval (P01) is required.

Q28. How should Firestone Wilderness AT tire replacements be handled if there is no approved tire on the list for the application in question (e.g. – F-150 vehicle equipped with P255/70 R16 tires)?

A28. There may be cases where a vehicle is equipped with 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tire sizes that are not included on the Ford-approved replacement list. These tires are not original equipment (OE) and, therefore, will not have an approved tire listed. In such cases, it is recommended that the customer install the proper OE tire, or have a tire of suitable quality installed. Reference the vehicle's "Safety Certification Label" and current "Ford Motor Company Tire Price Guide" for OE or suitable replacement recommendations.

Last Year's Firestone Tire Recall

Q29. Is this another Firestone program?

A29. No, this is a Ford sponsored program.

Q30. We replaced a customer's tires with Firestone Wilderness AT tires last fall; do we have to replace them again?

A30. Yes, these tires will be replaced.

Q31. Customers are asking – "why didn't we change their tires last year under the original Firestone Recall?" Why are they having to come back now?

A31. The original Firestone Recall was based on the data available at that time. Based on Ford's substantial testing since the Firestone Recall and recent data provided by Firestone have prompted Ford Motor Company to offer this program.

Certified Tire Dealer (AtW and Ford Tire Program) Information

Q32. I'm a small AtW dealership without a local distributor – will Ford assist with the freight costs to have tires shipped to our store?

A32. Yes, freight is reimbursable. Dealers are encouraged to arrange for shipment of 4 or more tires at a time.

Q33. During the Firestone Recall we ran out of tires almost immediately – what is Ford doing to make sure that tires are available?

A33. We are working with all major tire manufacturers to ramp up production to help meet demand. We are also stopping production at some of our assembly plants to divert tires toward this program.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Q34. I am a Certified Tire Dealer (AtW/Ford Tire Program) can I still file for tire warranty adjustments through Firestone?
A34. Effective June 22, 2001, Certified Tire Dealers (AtW and Ford Tire Program) can no longer file for warranty adjustments through Firestone.

Q35. As certified tire Dealer, may I sublet my in-stock and customer vehicles?
A35. No, Certified Tire Dealers may not sublet tire replacements. If circumstances prevent a Certified Tire Dealer from replacing tires, the necessary steps should be taken:

1. *Take affected vehicles to another Certified Tire Dealer (AtW/Ford Tire Program) or a local tire dealer authorized to perform no-cost Wilderness AT tire replacements, and have the tires replaced at no charge. (The Ford AtW dealer or tire store that replaced the tires will submit a claim that will close the open ONP on the VIN.)*
2. *The original Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program) will submit a 01B77 ONP claim using the miscellaneous expense code of "**SCHP**" (with a dollar value of $15.00 to cover administrative costs). Do not claim the "Admin" labor operation.*

Q36. We have been contacted by a local agency about used tires stored at my dealership. Where can I find information relative to tire storage and disposal/recycle requirements?
A36. As a result of ONP 01B77, some State and Local agencies are inspecting Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealerships to ascertain their compliance to local used tire handling requirements. It is the responsibility of the Dealer to be aware of, understand, and comply with all State and Local requirements. Please refer to the Ford Around the Wheel Program or Ford Tire Program Tire Administration Guide and contact the appropriate agencies in your market area for additional details. A list of suggested contacts can be found in the Tire Administration Section of the Tire Administration Guide.

Non-Certified Tire Dealer (AtW/Ford Tire Program) Information

Q37. As a non-certified tire Dealer, may I sublet my in-stock and customer vehicles?
A37. No, non-Certified Tire Dealers may not sublet tire replacements. The necessary steps are as follows:

1. Take affected vehicles to a Certified Tire Dealer (AtW/Ford Tire Program) or a local tire dealer authorized to perform no-cost Wilderness AT tire replacements, and have the tires replaced at no charge. (The Ford AtW dealer or tire store will submit a claim that will close the open ONP on the VIN.)
2. The non-Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program) will submit a 01B77 ONP claim using the miscellaneous expense code of "**SCHP**" (with a dollar value of $15.00 to cover administrative costs). Do not claim the "Admin" labor operation.

NOTE: This approach is consistent with steps non-AtW dealers would take to service a customer's vehicle under the 2001 bumper-to-bumper tire warranty and restricts tire usage to only the approved tire list.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company

Non-Ford or Lincoln Mercury Vehicle Information

Q38. We are a Certified Tire Dealer (AtW or Ford Tire Program) and sold a set of 15- inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires to a customer for a non-Ford vehicle - do we have to replace them?

A38. Yes, the repair should be submitted using a Warranty/ESP claim type claim form. The dealer **must** enter Program Code "**P19**", this will allow the repair to be submitted without a VIN. The causal part must be TIRE, with the actual part numbers for reimbursement at dealer cost plus 25%, and use actual time for labor reimbursement. These types of claims **cannot** be submitted as an Owner Notification Repair type.

Q39. What if a customer with a Mazda vehicle is requesting tire replacement from a Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealer?

A39. Refer the customer to a local Mazda dealer. Mazda dealers have Firestone Tire replacement program details for their vehicle lines. The Special Service Support Center will not give approval codes for Mazda vehicles.

© Copyright 2001 Ford Motor Company